

Desmond Yemeh, PharmD

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A committed pharmacist with a strong record of versatility, demonstrated through active involvement in multidisciplinary research, leadership, academic instruction, and patient-centered hospital care. A career that has included meaningful contributions to key public health decisions and collaborations by analyzing and communicating data effectively with end-users. Driven by a passion to advance pharmaceutical care and delivery and enhance individual quality of life. A broad interdisciplinary background that brings a competitive edge to practice and research in pharmaceutical sciences.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Pharmacy – Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)

Doctor of Philosophy in Aging Studies – Tulane University (Expected 2029)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- | | | |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------|
| ♦ Drug Design | ♦ Drug Discovery | ♦ Adherence to therapy |
| ♦ Substance Abuse | ♦ Aging & Neurodegenerative diseases | ♦ Data Science |

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Integrated Logistics Research - KNUST (2023 - 2024)

Project Title: *Ghana Integrated Logistics Management Information System – Assessing the Impact of Enhanced Logistics Management on Patient Outcomes*

- Recruited 10+ participants across five regions in northern Ghana for a study evaluating the impact of logistics management systems on patient outcomes.
- Coordinated 5+ virtual survey-based interviews, managing participant communication, scheduling, and Zoom logistics to support data collection.

Rational Use of Medicine Survey in Issa Polyclinic - Ghana (2020–2024)

Project Title: *Analysis of Antibiotic Use Trends Among Outpatient Clients*

- Conducted 15 quarterly rational medicine-use assessments from 2020–2024, analyzing prescribing practices and presenting findings to facility leadership and clinical staff.
- Implemented 4 evidence-based prescribing interventions to reduce outpatient polypharmacy, inappropriate antibiotic and injection use, and formulary nonadherence.

Survey on Staff Attitudes and Attendance at Clinical Meetings – Issa Polyclinic (July 2022)

Project Title: *Assessment of Staff Attitudes Toward Clinical Meetings and Their Impact on Patient Outcomes*

- Collaborated on a 4-member research team to survey 30+ healthcare staff on clinical meetings and their perceived impact on clinical outcomes.
- Presented findings and delivered evidence-informed training to 60 healthcare professionals on improving clinical practice, patient outcomes, and quality of life.

Undergraduate Research – KNUST (2017)

Project Title: *Quality Evaluation of Selected Anti-Microbial “Triple Action” Creams in the Kumasi Metropolis*

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- Evaluated selected “triple-action” antimicrobial creams in Kumasi, Ghana through in vitro testing to assess pharmaceutical quality and antimicrobial effectiveness.
- Confirmed acceptable product quality and antimicrobial activity but identified reduced antifungal effectiveness, supporting recommendations for increased surveillance and GMP compliance.

PUBLICATIONS

Netsey, E., Naandam, S., Asante, J., Kuukua, A., Yadem, A., Owusu, G., Shaffer, J., Srivastav, S., Doumbia, S., Owusu-Dabo, E., Morkle, C., **Yemeh, D.**, Manortey, S., Yankson, E., Sangare, M., & Kakraba, S. (2025). *Structural and Functional Impacts of SARS-CoV-2 Spike Protein Mutations: Insights from Predictive Modeling and Analytics*. <https://doi.org/10.2196/73637>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Issa Polyclinic – Upper West, Ghana

2020 – 2024

Manager of Pharmaceutical Services, Issa Polyclinic (2020 – 2024)

- Addressed limited medicine availability by directing procurement, inventory, and supply chain operations, increasing availability from 40% to over 70% and launching 24-hour pharmacy services.
- Addressed underreporting of adverse drug reactions by leading pharmacovigilance training and implementation, increasing reports from zero to over 10 monthly.
- Reduced medication safety risks by reviewing prescriptions for 60+ inpatients and 300+ outpatients monthly, using interdisciplinary ward rounds and allergy documentation.
- Led staff welfare initiatives and increased staff participation in welfare from 40% to over 85% to enhance team morale and performance

Manager, ART and TB Clinic, Issa Polyclinic (2022–2024)

- Established and managed dedicated ART and TB clinics, expanding access to specialized treatment and supporting care for 30+ HIV clients and 5+ TB clients annually.
- Managed daily clinic operations and coordinated patient flow, documentation, treatment follow-up, and continuity of care for more than 35 ART and TB clients annually.
- Collaborated with physicians, nurses, and multidisciplinary healthcare teams to support treatment adherence, care coordination, and continuity of care for 35+ ART and TB clients annually.

Vice Chairperson, Drug and Therapeutics Committee, Issa Polyclinic (2020 – 2024)

- Coordinated Drug and Therapeutics Committee initiatives that reduced average polypharmacy from five to three medications per patient, a 40% reduction, while promoting rational medication use.
- Trained over 50 multidisciplinary healthcare professionals, including physicians, nurses, anesthetists, and laboratory and pharmacy technicians, on appropriate prescribing practices and antimicrobial stewardship.
- Reviewed and updated more than 50 clinical treatment guidelines and protocols to align with current evidence-based recommendations and established a structured process for ongoing review and updates.

Pharmacist, Entity Tender Committee, Issa Polyclinic (2020–2024)

- Supported four annual procurement cycles for a portfolio of 150+ pharmaceutical products, contributing to procurement planning, supplier evaluation, and logistics coordination for an annual budget of approximately GHS 200,000.
- Evaluated 10+ suppliers to support cost-effective sourcing, product quality, and continuity of pharmaceutical supplies.
- Led procurement and inventory optimization initiatives that increased essential medicine availability from 40% to over 70%, a 30+ percentage-point improvement.

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Clinical Care Coordinator, Issa Polyclinic (2020 – 2024)

- Coordinated 50+ clinical meetings and training sessions annually for over 70 multidisciplinary healthcare professionals, strengthening clinical practice standards and continuous quality improvement.
- Directed infection prevention and control initiatives in collaboration with the IPC team, strengthening adherence to IPC protocols and supporting efforts to reduce healthcare-associated infections across the facility.
- Organized annual blood donation drives that engaged more than 20 donors to support local blood supply needs.

Acting Medical Superintendent, Issa Polyclinic (May–July 2021)

- Led polyclinic-wide clinical and administrative operations during a three-month appointment as Acting Medical Superintendent, overseeing 70+ staff, a 70+ bed inpatient facility, and care delivery for over 360 patients monthly.

Chairperson, NHIS Claims Vetting Committee, Issa Polyclinic (2020 – 2024)

- Led the vetting and submission of 350+ NHIS claims monthly, increasing reimbursement rates from 50% to 80% while reducing claim deductions and penalties

Chairperson, Quality Assurance Team, Issa Polyclinic (2020 –2024)

- Led 5+ facility-wide quality improvement and patient safety initiatives, training more than 50 staff and implementing programs in infection prevention and control, fire safety, neonatal mortality reduction, mass-casualty preparedness, and patient and staff satisfaction improvement.

Chairperson, Disciplinary Committee, Issa Polyclinic (2020 – 2024)

- Chaired 10 disciplinary hearings with a 100% case resolution rate, ensuring fair, transparent, and policy-compliant outcomes.

Pharmacist, TB & MDR-TB Management Team, DBI District, UW, Ghana (2021 – 2024)

- Ensured continuous medication access and monitored treatment adherence through directly observed therapy (DOT) for 10+ TB and MDR-TB patients annually, supporting 100% documented treatment adherence.
- Reported suspected adverse drug reactions to the Food and Drugs Authority and supported pharmacovigilance monitoring for TB and MDR-TB therapies.

Pharmacist, COVID-19 Rapid Response Team, DBI District (2021 – 2024)

- Managed medication, PPE, and essential medical supply logistics across 10+ healthcare facilities during the COVID-19 response, supporting uninterrupted access to critical supplies, including IV fluids and essential medications.

Cape Coast Teaching Hospital - Ghana

2019 – 2020

Intern Tutor

- Co-mentored 5 pharmacy interns during hospital rotations, providing practical training in clinical pharmacy, medication management, and patient-centered care.

Aspee Pharmaceuticals Limited - Intern

2017

- Supported quality assurance and GMP compliance activities for 5+ pharmaceutical products, including tablets, syrups, and suspensions, gaining hands-on experience in pharmaceutical manufacturing quality systems.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Dr. Hilla Limann Technical University - Ghana

2021 - 2022

Part-Time Lecturer

- Designed and delivered the Social Pharmacy curriculum to 104 final-year HND Dispensing Technician students, achieving a 100% pass rate and 72.98% average course performance.

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- Managed end-to-end course delivery, including curriculum planning, instruction, assessments, grading, and academic support.

Ashgin Pharmacy – Ghana

2019 – 2020

Intern Tutor

- Mentored and provided hands-on training to 3 pharmacy interns in community pharmacy practice, including dispensing, patient counseling, and medication management.
- Trained and supported 8+ pharmacy technicians and medicine counter assistants, strengthening competencies in dispensing, inventory management, customer service, and medication safety.

Cape Coast Teaching Hospital - Ghana

2019 – 2020

Intern Tutor

- Co-mentored 5 pharmacy interns during hospital rotations, providing practical training in clinical pharmacy, medication management, and patient-centered care.
- Contributed to the interns' understanding of clinical pharmacy practice in a hospital setting

PRESENTATIONS

Machine Learning-Enhanced Quantitative Structure-Activity Relationship Modeling for DNA Polymerase Inhibitor Discovery: Algorithm Development and Validation	2026
<u>Desmond Yemeh</u> , Samuel Kakraba, Srinivas Ayyadevara, Aayire Yadem Clement, Kuukua E. Abraham, Cesar M. Compadre, Robert J. Shmookler Reis – Tulane Research Innovation and Creativity Summit	
Discovery of DNA Polymerase Inhibitors: Machine Learning–Enhanced QSAR Modeling Approach	2025
<u>Desmond Yemeh</u> , Samuel Kakraba, Srinivas Ayyadevara, Aayire Yadem Clement, Kuukua E. Abraham, Cesar M. Compadre, Robert J. Shmookler Reis. – Demystifying AI in Public Health Symposium	
Rational Use of Medicine Presentation – Issa Polyclinic	2023
Appropriate Prescribing and Rational Use of Medicine Presentation/Training – Issa Polyclinic	2022
Staff Attitude toward Clinical Meetings – Issa Polyclinic	2022
Annual Health Review Presentation for Issa Polyclinic – Daffiama Bussei Issa District	2021
Poster Presentation on Quality Assessment of Sampled Anti-Microbial Creams in the Kumasi Metropolis - Ghana	2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Applications: Office 365, Discovery studio, Pymol, Maestro, swisspdb, MEGA, Treeage

Languages/Frameworks: Python, Bash, SQL

Statistical Analysis: SAS, R, STATA

Operating Systems: Windows, Linux, Ubuntu

Laboratory Skills: ELISA's, SDS PAGE, Western Blots

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SERVICE

President, Tulane African Students Association

2025 – 2026

- Increased TASA membership by 50% by expanding engagement among graduate and undergraduate students from diverse academic and cultural backgrounds.
- Partnered with university organizations to deliver 3+ intercultural programs engaging over 100 students, faculty, and staff, including a soccer tournament with 30+ participants.
- Organized and moderated 2 career-development events featuring alumni and faculty, connecting more than 50 students with academic and professional insights to support career development.

Founder, Afro Nola, New Orleans

2024 – Date

- Co-founded and led Afro Nola, a wellness and recreation group of 80+ members; including students and workers, that promotes health, fitness, and community through sports.

Organizer, Pharmaceutical Society of Ghana (PSGH) – Upper West Branch, Ghana 2023 – 2024

- Organized 2 regional health walks engaging 20+ pharmacy professionals to promote health awareness.
- Coordinated 3+ community health outreach programs, reaching 100+ individuals with education on substance use and chronic disease management.

Public Health Committee Organizer, PSGH – Upper West Branch, Ghana

2021 – 2024

- Led public health outreach initiatives providing free chronic disease screenings to over 50 community members.

VOLUNTEER WORK

Alzheimer's Association, Louisiana Chapter

2025 - Date

Smile Foundation Ghana

2018 - 2024

PROFESIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Pharmaceutical Society of Ghana

American Association of Pharmaceutical Scientists

Industry Pharmacists Organization

REFERENCES

Available upon request